

4.53 Best Dressed Competitions Novices' Hurdle (GBB Race)**£10,000 Total Race Value RTV****2m3f**For 4yo+ which have not won more than one hurdle **Weights** 4yo 10st 9lb; 5yo+ 11st 5lb
value 1st £5,446 **2nd** £2,509 **3rd** £1,254 **4th** £628**Penalties** a winner of a hurdle 7lb **Penalty****GOOD**

		Trainer	Jockey	SP	OR	TS	RPR
	Crest Of Stars 5 11-12t	A Honeyball	Chad Bament (7)	3-1	112	98	119
2m maiden hurdle (good) winner here in January; disappointed on heavy ground over C&D after but bounced back when a staying-on third on handicap debut at Ludlow (2m, good) last time, suggesting he'd be worth another try at this trip; respected back in a novice with Chad Bament claiming 7lb.							
	Docteur Romeo 5 11-5	N Martin	James Best	50-1	-	54	74
Well held in his sole bumper, in December 2024, and he's offered little in two starts over hurdles (2m-2m2f), both on good to soft, since returning from a long absence.							
	Kilnew Supreme 5 11-5t	P Nicholls	Freddie Gingell	6-4	-	90	113
Runner-up in an Irish 3m point behind a subsequent good hurdle winner; has since shaped with promise in a Wincanton bumper and maiden hurdle (1m7f; good) for this stable, the latter following wind surgery; not beaten far on any of those occasions and there could be a good bit of improvement forthcoming now going up in trip.							
	Royal Rocket 5 11-5	E Lavelle	Stan Sheppard	20-1	-	13	-
Showed some promise in a Chepstow bumper (soft) last month but he weakened markedly upped in trip on hurdle debut there (2m7f, good to soft) since, when running too freely; drop back in trip may suit but likely needs more time and experience before showing his best.							
	Warfleet 6 11-5h	J Frost	James Davies	66-1	-	53	74
Showed promise when runner-up in one of three bumpers in 2024 but he's only managed the two runs since, pulling up on hurdle debut last March and finishing tailed off when returning from an absence 18 days ago for new yard.							
	Winning Paddy 8 11-5	A Dunn	Richie McLernon	33-1	-	-	-
1-11 in Irish points but his recent efforts have been uninspiring back from an absence and he changed hands for £2,000 in March; faces a tough task on stable/rules debut.							
	Parchment 4 11-2w t	D Pipe	Jack Tudor	6-4	-	71	119
French hurdle winner (2m1f, very soft) in June, but he disappointed when sent off a short-priced favourite on stable debut at Kempton (2m, good) in November; off since but he's been given wind surgery and it would be no surprise should he leave that effort behind.							

SPOTLIGHT VERDICT **Parchment** is certainly capable of better than he showed at Kempton and he's feared on his return from a break and wind surgery. **Crest Of Stars** suggested that a return to this trip could unlock improvement but **KILNEW SUPREME** is another who looks set to benefit from this longer trip and is narrowly preferred. [Tim Mitchell]

5.30 Royal Ascot Lunch Saturday 20 June Mares' Handicap Hurdle**£9,000** Total Race Value **RTV****3m**For 4yo+ fillies & mares Rated 0-100 Minimum weight 10-2 Penalties after April 11th, each hurdle won 7lb Penalty value 1st
£4,752.90 2nd £2,187 3rd £1,093.50 4th £547.20 5th £272.70**GOOD**

	Trainer	Jockey	SP	OR	TS	RPR
 Lady Caro 8 12-0	E Lavelle	Cameron Johnstone-Baker (7)	7-4	100	93	101
2-16 in handicaps, raised to 3m here (good) for last three outings; ridden by Cameron Johnstone-Baker last month on last two starts, runner-up before winning easily with a career best four weeks ago (Miss Tiara third); 8lb higher today but needs plenty of respect.						
 Jena D'Oudairies 7 12-0b ¹	P Nicholls	Freddie Gingell	9-1	100	92	101
Down the weights but lack of impact in six handicaps (two over this sort of trip) prevents any confidence in her taking advantage; has worn tongue-tie and cheekpieces in recent starts, which are now replaced with blinkers.						
 Border Gem 6 11-7	J Scott	Chad Bament (7)	4-1	93	80	107
Nine-race maiden but she's a reliable sort, runner-up at Hereford (2m4f, good) last time, and looks worth a crack at this sort of trip.						
 Miss Tiara 6 11-6t	J Scott	Lorcan Williams	5-1	92	95	99
Had wind surgery (her second) before penultimate start; reportedly made a respiratory noise that day but performed much better when staying-on third of ten to Lady Caro over C&D (good) last time, albeit making it look very hard work in comparison with the winner; has 9lb swing in the weights for a near 7l beating.						
 Hurst Hill 7 11-2	J S Mullins	Daniel Sansom (3)	6-1	88	96	102
Opened account at Newton Abbot (2m6f, good) last July and runner-up in three of her four starts since, at up to 3m3f; on the premises on that evidence but the 163 days off ask a question.						
 Poet's Muse 5 10-13	I Chanin	Ciaran Gethings	33-1	85	48	84
Won a 3m maiden point last May; beaten 56l, 46l and 63l this year in her three hurdle races (at up to an extended 2m5f) so does not have any form claims, and she reportedly bled from the nose last time; steps back up in trip for this handicap debut.						
 Pooley's Promise 7 10-5tp ¹	N Mulholland	Richie McLernon	5-1	77	85	104
2lb lower than for Ffos Las win (3m, good) for Ryan Potter last May; soft ground might be blamed for two heavy defeats late last year and perhaps she needed the race when unable to justify market prominence on recent stable debut behind two of these over C&D last month; wore cheekpieces last time and also tongue tied today; interesting to see if her backers return.						
 Bee's Kiss 6 10-2	J Frost	James Best	40-1	74	-	-
Won a good-ground Irish point last May but heavy defeats in her four hurdle races; now goes handicapping with a big rethink on trip (last three races were at about 2m) but also from 8lb out of the handicap proper.						

SPOTLIGHT VERDICT While cases can be argued for a few of the others, the safest option seems to be **LADY CARO (nap)** who has been a rising force since upped to 3m at this track and won easily last time out. The revised weights make it much more difficult in theory but she is still preferred to **Miss Tiara** who was third to her in that race. **Border Gem**, upped in trip, is third on the list, given that **Hurst Hill** has not been seen in recent action.[Richard Austen]

6.00 Ron Hatton Memorial Handicap Hurdle**£10,500 Total Race Value** **RTV****2m3f**For 4yo+ Rated 0-110 (also open to such horses rated 111 and 112 - see Standard Conditions)
April 11th, each hurdle won 7lb **Penalty value 1st** £5,545.05 **2nd** £2,551.50 **3rd** £1,275.75 **4th** £638.40 **5th** £318.15**Minimum weight 10-2 Penalties after****GOOD**

		Trainer	Jockey	SP	OR	TS	RPR
	Dirty Den 6 12-2p	S Hosie	Paddy Hanlon (5)	10-1	112	93	111
Hooded when solid third over C&D (good) at the end of last year and scored at Plumpton (about 2m4f, soft) on next start in February; revised mark has seen him held in two subsequent starts but that doesn't tell the whole story as they were seriously competitive series qualifiers; cheekpieces (worn once over hurdles when second here 13 months ago) are reapplied and he needs a firm second look.							
	Myrighthandman 5 11-11t	T Lacey	Stan Sheppard	3-1	107	87	109
3m Irish point winner (favourite) who recorded similar RPRs in three maiden hurdles (about 2m, good to soft/good) across February and March; point win and pedigree suggest this step up in trip should suit; of obvious interest on this handicap debut.							
	Public Enemy 5 11-7tv	A Honeyball	James Robottom (10)	14-1	103	106	111
Won good-ground maiden and novice hurdles last spring but he hasn't fired in handicaps, including in a tongue-tie on his last two starts and with added cheekpieces (now swapped for a visor) at Plumpton a fortnight ago; handicapper is trying to help but others look safer.							
	Bobbarelli 9 11-6ht	N & W Twiston-Davies	Miss Amber Jackson-Fennell (7)	10-1	102	104	108
9yo who was 2-12 in points (the wins coming over 2m4f on good/good to firm); weakened on February's belated hurdling debut (soft) and couldn't convert what turned into a golden opportunity at Warwick (2m5f, good) four weeks ago; handicap debut and may yet do better in this sphere.							
	Best Night 5 11-6t	D Pipe	Jack Tudor	4-1	102	79	112
22-1 when she made a winning stable debut in Newton Abbot novice (2m1f) in September and was a respectable fourth of 13 in C&D handicap (also good to soft) in January; doubled her tally when scoring at Huntingdon (2m, good) last month but it was a tired mistake at the last when 15l second a fortnight later; still needs considering.							
	Green Sky 6 11-3b ¹	D Pipe	Rian Corcoran (5)	14-1	99	91	111
Beaten just 2l when fourth at Newton Abbot (2m1f, good) earlier in the month but Friday's heavy defeat on similar ground at Exeter (extended 2m2f) takes some explaining; swaps cheekpieces for blinkers and her yard might have better prospects with Best Night.							
	Midnight Pass 5 11-1	E Lavelle	Charlie Todd	6-1	97	83	100
Finding her feet over hurdles and October's third at Hereford (2m, good) when last seen was quite encouraging; pedigree suggests this new trip can unlock more and she's one to be interested in on this handicap debut despite the absence.							
	Taritino 6 10-12	J Tickle	Bryan Carver	5-1	94	102	110
Landed a 'hands and heels' event over C&D in March and respectable efforts in two subsequent starts, latterly when second off this mark at Exeter (about 2m2f, also good; Green Sky tailed off) on Friday; on the premises again if this doesn't come too soon.							
	Forever Penywern 4 10-10h	W Greatrex	Harry Bannister	7-1	102	116	113
Signed off for William Haggas with a brace of selling wins (1m3f/1m2f) on the Flat late last summer; three goes over hurdles but his fair third at Stratford (about 2m2f, soft) in March wasn't matched either side of it; will need to have his Stratford hat on for this handicap debut but it's still early days and that's possible.							

SPOTLIGHT VERDICT Four of these are testing their marks for the first time. The leaders of that pack could be **Midnight Pass** and **Myrighthandman** (preferred in that order) but it's tempting to side with **DIRTY DEN**, who contested a couple of fiercely competitive handicaps on his last two starts and can be expected to do better this time.[Richard Russell]

6.30 Dave Criddle Travel Handicap Hurdle**£9,000 Total Race Value** **RTV****2m1/2f**

For 4yo + Rated 0-100 Minimum weight 10-2 Penalties after April 11th, each hurdle won 7lb Penalty value 1st £4,752.90 2nd £2,187 3rd £1,093.50 4th £547.20 5th £272.70

GOOD

	Trainer	Jockey	SP	OR	TS	RPR
 Old Bridge 5 12-0ht D Pipe Jack Tudor 7-2 100 82 99 0-13 over hurdles and has struggled a little with consistency in the past, with his better efforts coming over further; however, he went close off a similar mark at Hereford (2m3f, good) in November and, despite the drop back in trip and returning from a break, he still warrants respect.						
 Most Wanted 8 11-4 D Bridgwater Tom Cannon 25-1 90 74 101 Won over a mile on the Flat last summer but has yet to transfer that ability to hurdles, last seen pulling up at Plumpton (2m, good to soft) in October on handicap hurdle debut; returns from a 184-day break off 3lb lower, but still with a bit to prove.						
 Daring To Dream 5 11-3h Harriet Dickin James Best 7-1 89 81 98 Showed promise in her bumpers but had only hinted at that ability in three novice hurdles before stepping up on handicap debut when a keeping-on third from off the pace at Stratford (2m, good) last month; open to further progress and one to consider off 1lb lower.						
 Galactic Jack 6 11-0tp G & J Moore Caoilin Quinn 12-1 86 51 100 A useful middle-distance Flat performer, but still a maiden over hurdles after seven attempts and has yet to rediscover his form in two starts since returning from a long absence this season; likely best watched for now.						
 Pillar The Poet 6 11-0h I Chanin Ciaran Gethings 25-1 86 57 97 Finished a remote fourth over 2m3f here in February before taking a backward step when tailed off at Exeter (extended 2m5f, good) two weeks ago when tried in a hood (retained), both times ridden by a 7lb claimer; still lightly raced but needs to step up considerably.						
 Portcammon 7 10-13p N Mulholland Richie McLernon 12-1 85 95 101 Has dropped to a competitive mark on the pick of his form, but recent efforts have been underwhelming and the stable looks to have stronger claims with Little Lady Lucy; could come good at some point, but needs to turn things around.						
 Miss Fedora 7 10-9 N Scholfield Harry Reed 13-2 81 - 100 Signs of a revival when fourth over fences at Fakenham (2m5f) in January, before 3m5f stretched her (refused at the final fence) on final start for Seamus Mullins; offered little when sent off joint-favourite on stable debut last month; tongue-tie wore then quickly dispensed with and she reverts to hurdles on a workable mark, but with plenty to prove.						
 Little Lady Lucy 5 10-5p N Mulholland Bradley Harris (3) 15-8 77 76 102 Showed little in three runs at around 2m4f this season before finally opening her account over hurdles at the 12th attempt, when a switch to front-running tactics and a drop in trip at Wincanton (1m7f, good) ten days ago brought about the decisive breakthrough; subsequent penalty may not be enough to prevent another bold showing if she can replicate the effort.						
 Saucats 5 10-2t J Tickle Ben Godfrey 10-1 74 95 102 Longstanding maiden over hurdles who hasn't done enough to suggest he's about to shed his maiden tag, finishing 17.5l adrift of Little Lady Lucy at Wincanton (1m7f, good) last time; has a bit to find on the revised terms but not ruled out for minor honours.						
 Mi Sueno 7 10-2 D Brace Tristan Durrell 14-1 74 56 90 Dual soft-ground hurdle winner (handles good) in early 2024 but has struggled for form since, including on both starts for this stable; latest C&D effort offered a glimmer of encouragement and he's well treated on old form, but he needs another step forward today.						
 Blazing Gaden 5 10-2 D Jeffreys James Turner (5) 25-1 74 76 84 Has offered little in four runs over hurdles (soft/heavy), including on last month's handicap debut; needs the better ground to spark significant improvement.						

SPOTLIGHT VERDICT With **Old Bridge** (second choice) coming back in trip, **Little Lady Lucy** is unlikely to get the same uncontested lead she enjoyed at Wincanton last time, though she still commands respect under her penalty. However, with a strong pace likely, **DARING TO DREAM** could be the one to benefit, having shaped with encouragement at Stratford last time and looking open to further improvement. [Tim Mitchell]

7.00 Charles Clark Memorial Handicap Hurdle**£10,500 Total Race Value** **RTV****3m**For 4yo+ Rated 0-110 (also open to such horses rated 111 and 112 - see Standard Conditions)
April 11th, each hurdle won 7lb **Penalty value 1st** £5,545.05 **2nd** £2,551.50 **3rd** £1,275.75 **4th** £638.40 **5th** £318.15**Minimum weight 10-2 Penalties after****GOOD**

	Trainer	Jockey	SP	OR	TS	RPR
 Gasmani 7 12-0	D Dennis	Charlie Maggs (3)	5-2	110	96	112
Came good as a hurdler (sixth attempt) when asserting by 5l in a five-runner and four-finisher novice handicap over C&D (good) 13 days ago, having breezed into the lead before two out under Charlie Maggs; hot favourite Noble Blue unseated early in that race; up 6lb but probably has a good chance.						
 Holeshot 7 11-12	T Vaughan	Lorcan Williams	10-1	108	93	111
Chasing on last five starts has not really worked out; Taunton (2m3f) last February and Warwick (2m) last March saw him register a double over hurdles and he's back to his last winning mark for today's switch in codes but, after three non-completions at about 3m over fences, stamina also has to be proved.						
 Sam's Amour 9 11-9	Keiran Burke	Stan Sheppard	33-1	105	94	110
Triple hurdle winner (2m2f-2m5f) in 2024 but she struggled in her final three runs last year (reportedly bled from the nose on chase debut final time) and did so again when returned to action 18 days ago; now 7lb below her peak mark.						
 Sage Green 6 11-8t	S Hosie	James Best	5-1	104	104	111
Fell mid-race on chasing debut last month; better 18 days later on second attempt in that sphere (albeit last of three) and peak hurdles efforts make this look an attractive mark, but they were all at about 2m and this sort of trip is totally new under rules for this 2024 Irish 3m point winner.						
 Noble Blue 8 11-8	Mrs K Woollacott	Mr Joshua Newman (5)	7-4	104	102	112
0-14 under rules but 6-9 in points; second in two handicap hurdles over about 2m6f at Exeter this year, which saw him start 11-10 favourite for five-runner race over C&D (good) 13 days ago but he clipped heels and unseated in the early stages; that was the race won by Gasmani; should give him a lot more to think about this time, barring mishaps.						
 Final Entry 5 10-12tp	D Pipe	Jack Tudor	8-1	94	78	106
Lightly raced 5yo, absent 473 days before this season; showed some ability in 2024, so he's not totally ruled out over today's very new trip, despite being well held in his two runs (one on Flat) this year; tongue-tie (worn twice on Flat in Ireland at start of career) returns.						
 McGregors Charge 8 10-2	Mrs K Woollacott	Ben Godfrey	7-1	84	-	-
A chase at Perth (3m, good) last August off 5lb lower was his only win from 17 starts; left Ella Pickard before pulled up here 13 days ago on debut for new stable, but it's notable that he started 13-8 favourite in that chase; now he's back hurdling for first time since 2022.						

SPOTLIGHT VERDICT **Noble Blue** was 11-10 favourite for a five-runner handicap over C&D 13 days ago, while **GASMANI** was 17-2, but it was the latter who prevailed after the favourite unshipped his rider in an unfortunate incident in the early stages. Those who believed Noble Blue would win that day, after his two seconds at about 2m6f, may want to go in again now that Gasmani is 6lb worse off, but the ease of his win puts a rather different complexion on things. **Sage Green** is third on the list.[Richard Austen]

7.30 Dorset & Somerset Air Ambulance Novices' Limited Handicap**Hurdle****£9,000 Total Race Value** **RTV****2m3f**

For 4yo+ Rated 0-95 **Weights** highest weight 11st 12lb **Minimum weight** 10-5, **3-y-o** 10-2 **Penalties** after April 11th, each hurdle won 7lb
Penalty value 1st £4,752.90 2nd £2,187 3rd £1,093.50 4th £547.20 5th £272.70

GOOD

	Trainer	Jockey	SP	OR	TS	RPR
 Lake Tiberias 6 11-12	H Derham	Paul O'Brien	9-2	94	78	100
Hasn't quite built on a promising bumper debut since going over hurdles, including in a couple of handicaps; however, his recent 17l third when attracting support at Wincanton (2m4f, good) was more encouraging; easing in the weights and one to consider in a modest contest.						
 Tobi Kanabee 7 11-8	Mrs C Hitch	Ben Godfrey	20-1	90	84	99
Put in a bold bid from the front at Newton Abbot (extended 2m5f, good) last week before fading into a remote third late; remains on a tough mark and others have achieved more.						
 Peace In The Park 6 11-7	D Jeffreys	Tristan Durrell	16-1	89	67	94
Encouraging second on handicap debut at Huntingdon (2m, heavy), but that form has taken some knocks and he's been well held twice since on quicker ground; on a competitive mark but needs to bounce back..						
 Modern Style 4 10-13	N Hawke	James Best	4-5	91	72	107
Well-bred 4yo who improved markedly switched to handicaps when a wide-margin winner at Exeter (extended 2m, good) five days ago; the manner of the win suggests there's more to come; faces a quick turnaround and stamina to prove up in trip, but he looks well treated under a penalty and is the one to beat.						
 Forest Hills 5 10-10 ¹	C Gray	Ciaran Gethings	25-1	78	53	79
1m2f Flat winner who has yet to show anything of note over hurdles, including on handicap debut at Wincanton (1m7f, good) ten days ago; needs this step up in trip and the tongue-tie to spark considerable improvement.						
 No Mean Feat 7 10-10	S Hodgson	James Davies	12-1	78	77	96
0-14 over hurdles and has shown little in three runs (2m-2m4f) since returning from a long absence; cheekpieces tried last time quickly dispensed with; plenty to prove.						
 Galactic Princess 5 10-8w tp ¹	D Hitchins	Robbie David (5)	8-1	76	74	90
Modest Irish point form when second of three, and has been well held on all completed starts over hurdles (1m7f-2m6f), including a handicap last time; has since undergone wind surgery, while the hood is replaced with a tongue-tie and cheekpieces.						
 Athena's Dream 4 10-6b	Harriet Dickin	Miss Megan Bevan (7)	33-1	84	81	98
Has yet to build on the promise of her bumper debut since switched to hurdles and was beaten 29l when tried at 2m4f and in blinkers at Wincanton last time on handicap debut; still early days, but needs to find improvement.						
 Ritaan 4 10-5	Ms G Nicholls	Mr Harry Brown (7)	14-1	81	63	94
Fair Flat maiden but yet to progress over hurdles and has often raced too keenly, though was a bit more tractable back at 2m last time without ever getting involved; hood removed now back up in trip and may do better at some point, but she remains a work in progress for now.						
 Future Times 6 10-5	G Edwards	Mr Jack Stenhouse (7)	14-1	73	60	91
Longstanding maiden who didn't run badly on first two starts back from a mammoth absence; out of the weights but not hard to see him hitting the frame in a weak contest, if bouncing back from a poor effort last time.						
 Joker Jack 7 10-5w tp	Mrs C Hitch	Lorcan Murtagh	50-1	73	28	-
Pulled up on two of his three starts this season, including on chase debut in February and when tried in this headgear combination back over hurdles last time; has undergone wind surgery since but still looks best watched.						

SPOTLIGHT VERDICT This looks very winnable and a good opportunity for last week's wide-margin Exeter winner **MODERN STYLE** to follow up under a penalty and make it 2-2 since switched to handicaps, despite the quick turnaround. **Lake Tiberias** rates the clear second choice. [Tim Mitchell]